

IGOR TRON

Senior Software Engineer – PHP / WordPress / JavaScript

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PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience building and operating PHP and WordPress systems, including high-traffic platforms and large-scale multi-site architectures. Deep experience in performance optimization, database design and refactoring, debugging across application and infrastructure layers, CI/CD, and technical architecture. Comfortable working across PHP, JavaScript, SQL, caching/CDN, search infrastructure, and production operations. Recently built reusable AI-agent workflows with Codex and Claude Code to automate repeatable engineering tasks while keeping testing, review, and engineering judgment in the loop. Long-term WordPress and open-source contributor with experience leading engineering work in distributed teams.

CORE SKILLS

Languages & Engineering: PHP 7/8, JavaScript, SQL, HTML5, CSS/SCSS, OOP, SOLID, TDD, PHPUnit, Xdebug, PHP Unit Tests

Data & Search: MySQL/MariaDB, Elasticsearch, Algolia, query optimization, replication

Performance & Reliability: Core Web Vitals, caching/CDN, profiling, production debugging, fault-tolerant architecture

WordPress: Custom plugins/themes/MU-plugins, Gutenberg, REST API, WP-CLI, Multisite, hooks & filters, custom tables, WordPress Unit Tests

Infrastructure & Delivery: Composer, Docker, nginx, Git/GitFlow, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Cloudflare, Amazon S3

AI-assisted Engineering: Codex, Claude Code, reusable agent skills/workflows, implementation and review automation

SELECTED ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

- High-traffic performance: refactored backend/database queries, tuned Cloudflare caching, and moved workloads toward cloud-based architecture to improve frontend performance and fault tolerance under load.
- Editor experience: designed editor-focused WordPress admin interfaces and reusable content components to make day-to-day publishing faster and safer.
- Security and delivery: implemented role/capability controls, hardened CI/CD workflows, strict file permissions, and opinionated WordPress configuration to reduce unauthorized or accidental production changes.
- Automated content: delivered fully automated and semi-automated import pipelines for projects with continuously updated content.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead WordPress Engineer | Cointelegraph

2023–2025

New York, United States / Remote

- Led architecture for a shared WordPress platform powering dozens of related sites from a single codebase, reducing duplication and making long-term maintenance more predictable.
- Led a small engineering team through task planning, mentoring, code reviews, architectural decisions, and technical debt management.
- Improved performance and reliability of high-traffic WordPress platforms through database query optimization, Cloudflare caching, S3 static asset offloading, MySQL replication, and Elasticsearch/Algolia integration.
- Diagnosed production issues across WordPress/PHP, MySQL, caching/CDN, search services, and infrastructure, tracing problems across system layers instead of treating symptoms in isolation.
- Improved Core Web Vitals through asset bundling, CDN/cache tuning, S3 offloading, critical/deferred CSS strategies, and layout stabilization.
- Built reusable AI-agent workflows for WordPress delivery with Codex and Claude Code, reducing repeatable setup and implementation work from 10+ days to 1–2 days.

PHP Software Engineer | EPAM Systems

2021–2023

Moscow, Russia / Herceg-Novi, Montenegro

- Worked on a shared WordPress platform supporting 150+ brand sites from a single repository and standardized CI/CD workflow, enabling reusable development and consistent deployments across the platform.
- Contributed to an enterprise platform managing approximately 7,000 WordPress sites with separate databases, working with architecture and development patterns designed for maintainability at large scale.
- Developed custom WordPress themes, plugins, drop-ins, Gutenberg components, and REST API extensions for enterprise clients including Bacardi and Thomson Reuters.
- Optimized PHP and WordPress performance with object/page caching, database query optimization, and Algolia search services.
- Deeply refactored database queries, delivering up to 250% faster WordPress admin performance and up to 400% faster unauthenticated request processing.
- Developed a WordPress extension introducing new relationships between core entities through custom database tables, simplifying application code and reducing database operation costs.

PHP & WordPress Specialist | Independent / Freelance

2009–2021

Worldwide

- Built and launched hundreds of WordPress landing pages, corporate sites, custom themes, plugins, and integrations across a wide range of client projects.
- Migrated a publishing website from Django to WordPress, modelling non-standard data and relationships with custom post types, taxonomies, and custom tables across tens of thousands of records.
- Migrated hundreds of posts and comments from LiveJournal to WordPress while preserving content structure, discussion threads, media, and SEO where possible.
- Introduced PHPUnit and WordPress unit-test suites into projects to catch regressions earlier and promote a test-driven engineering mindset.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

- WordPress.org plugin author and open-source contributor.
- Participated in WordPress community events, including speaking at WordCamp Russia.
[WordPress.org profile](#) • [GitHub](#)

EDUCATION

Moscow Government Social University — Moscow, Russia